FARMLIFE

KCFB
KINGS COUNTY FARM BUREAU

OFFICIAL MONTHLY PUBLICATION OF THE KINGS COUNTY FARM BUREAU December 2024 Vol. 31 Number 12 kcfb.org

INSIDE

ANNUAL MEETING RECAP **PG. 5**

PETE HANSE AWARD **PG. 6**

SGMA RECAP **PG. 9**

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2024 HIGHLIGHTS

ADVOCACY

Media Interviews
KCFB was interviewed 21 times by media outlets.

Media Coverage
KCFB and our advocacy efforts were written or spoke about in the media 10 times this year.

KCWD Candidate Endorsements
KCFB Endorsed Paul Gillum and Andrew Brazil for the Kings County Water District Board.

KCWD Comments
KCFB delivered comments to the KCWD board on their decision to remove the water district from the MKRGSA.

Participated Tulare Lake Subbasin GSA Meetings

Participated Kings County Board of Supervisors Meetings

SGMA

SWRCB court appearances
KCFB sued the SWRCB for placing the Tulare Lake Subbasin on probation under SGMA. KCFB appeared in court 7 times in 2024.

Water committee meetings
KCFB held 20 water committee meetings in 2024.

Water Forum
KCFB held a SGMA focused Water Forum with over 40 community members in attendance

SGMA Defense Fund
Community members invested over $250,000 into KCFB's lawsuit against the SWRCB.

MKRGSA Prop 218 block
KCFB delivered comments and gathered petition signatures to block the MKRGSA Prop 218.

EKRCD

Hosted 2 Conservation Stewardship Program lunches

Received a $5M Healthy Soils (HSP) Block Grant
Awarded $2.8M to fund 23 on farm projects in round 1 of the HSP grant

Received a $500,000 Water Efficiency Technical Assistance (WETA) block grant
Created the Well Evaluation Lab Learning Understanding Planning (WELLUP) Program

Funded 14 pump efficiency tests for growers

OUTREACH

Farm Life Online
Sent 18 Farm Life Online publications

E-Blasts
Sent 31 E-Blasts

Put on Farm Day
Over 2,000 Kings County third graders attended our 2024 Farm Day

3 Scholarships

1 New Staff Member

340/383 Membership renewal
Renewed 89% of our 2023 members, added 16 new members to membership

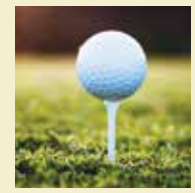
Membership Appreciation Night
350 tickets were given away to attend the 2024 Membership Appreciation Night at Rawhide

2 Promo videos

Podcast episodes
Started a podcast and hosted 4 episodes

Text campaigns
Sent 4 text campaigns

Hanford Sentinel articles
Executive Director contributed 6 agriculture articles to the Hanford Sentinel



Record breaking Harvest Classic Golf Tournament
145 players and 41 sponsors helped make this years Harvest Classic Golf Tournament the most successful yet

Farm Life Issues
Published 12 Farm Life issues

106th Annual Meeting

KCFB
KINGS COUNTY FARM BUREAU

Purpose
Protect, preserve and enhance agriculture in Kings County

Vision
Ensure that every farmer has the right to farm and protect their heritage

Values
Our Members | Proactive Representative
Reliable | Trusted Resource

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Secretary/Treasurer: Chad Souza

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Keith Grabow
Pete Hanse
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Brian Medeiros
Michael Miya
Brian Potter
Kevin Robertson
Helen Sullivan
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A look back on 2024

By Dusty Ference, Executive Director

Dusty Ference

2024 has been a year for the record books! In January, KCFB's board of directors adopted three organizational goals to focus on this year: SGMA advocacy, the Excelsior-Kings River Resource Conservation District, and candidate development for local elections. I am excited by the focus these goals have created for the board and staff and the amazing accomplishments KCFB achieved this year.

As you know, KCFB has taken on the State Water Resources Control Board's (SWRCB) decision to place the Tulare Lake Subbasin on probation under the Sustainable Groundwater Management Act. While KCFB gets a lot of credit for that effort, we have not done it alone. Our members in and around Kings County deserve the credit. You and your neighbors, families, and friends have rallied together and funded the effort, investing more than $250,000 in legal fees alone and saving the subbasin millions in fees to the SWRCB. We are making tremendous progress and will continue fighting to keep the SWRCB off your farms.

Several years ago, the Excelsior-Kings River Resource Conservation District (EKRCD) hired KCFB to manage the district and find the necessary funding to bring it back to life. With a dedicated board of directors, a few generous partners, and a lot of work, EKRCD secured more than $5.5 million in grant funding in 2024. Two programs through CDFA allow EKRCD to invest in projects on farms in and around Kings County. We covered them extensively in Farm Life, so I'll skip the details in this issue. But I won't miss the opportunity to showcase the value of partnerships and highlight KCFBs dedication to improving conditions for growers in the county.

KCFB's third goal was likely the most controversial. However, this year has proven how impactful KCFB's involvement in local politics can be. For the first time in many years, KCFB's board of directors has chosen to endorse candidates. The difference this year from the past is the focus on local elections. KCFB recognized a need for change in leadership in a district with significant implications for many of our members. With that in mind, KCFB's directors went to work vetting candidates to run for office and ultimately endorsing them. But the endorsement wasn't the only significant part of the effort. It was possibly more important to draw attention to the election and let voters know why it is crucial to understand what and who they had the opportunity to vote for.

KCFB also recognized the need to refresh its communication style and methods considering these goals. Most notably, KCFB started the Farm Life podcast in August. The show is designed for KCFB and its guests to discuss the issues impacting Kings County farms and ranches more in-depth than KCFB can write about. It can be found on your preferred podcast platform. Additionally, KCFB realized the need for quick, impactful communication and added the ability to text

our membership when time is of the essence. Lastly, KCFB recognized the value in communicating with the community at large and is writing articles regularly for the Hanford Sentinel as a tool to spread the word about our work outside of the membership.

With outstanding leadership from the board of directors, hard work from our dedicated staff, and unwavering support from our membership, KCFB thrived this year. 2025 will undoubtedly be an exciting year. Hopefully, our case against the SWRCB will be decided, and GSAs will update their GSPs to satisfy DWR while allowing Kings County agriculture to thrive. But no matter what the year brings, KCFB will proudly continue fighting for your right to farm!

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Content for this month's "Ag News in Brief," provided by the California Farm Bureau Federation

SWRCB Releases Draft Order Revising Central Calley Dairy Order

On October 1, 2024, the State Water Resources Control Board released a draft order revising the Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board's existing dairy order. The draft order creates a new regulatory framework for nitrogen discharges and makes certain components precedential for dairies statewide. Comments are due on December 6, 2024.

H5N1 in Dairies

Several important guidance documents related to HPAI were recently released or re-released.

Find descriptions and links to them below.

Joint Guidance on Worker Safety Related to HPAI

In order to clarify requirements related to protecting dairy workers during HPAI outbreaks on dairies, CDFA, CDPH and Cal/OSHA (with others) jointly issued "State of California Guidance on Bird Flu for Workers and Employers". Highlights of the guidance include:

- **The State and Federal governments maintain the risk to the general public is low.** No person-to-person spread had been demonstrated in California or the U.S. All persons in California who have become infected had direct contact with infected cows. The small number of human cases in the state have reported mild symptoms, primarily eye infections ("Pink-Eye") or mild flu-like symptoms. All human cases have responded well to treatment and none have been hospitalized.
- **Guidance for worker PPE has been established.The document links to specific guidance for worker PPE.** Importantly producers must providerespiratory protection, such as an N95 mask, and eye protection such as goggles or face shield. Additional requirements may be implemented depending on how an "enclosed area" is defined on a dairy. CDQAP and your trade organizations will provide additional information as it becomes available. For farms with confirmed HPAI cases, producers can request direct shipments of PPE, at least until December 1st 2024. .
- **Workers who become infected have assistance.** A worker who suspects he has become infected can obtain free testing and treatment through their local county public health department. Local health departments do not require or collect Social Security numbers or residency status information. Employees who become infected are also eligible for workers' compensation benefits.

Republicans Win Government Trifecta

The 2024 elections proved to be a significant win for Republicans, with former President Donald Trump set to retake the White House and the GOP claiming majorities in both the House and Senate. A sweep of nearly every battleground state resulted in convincing a 312-226 Electoral College win, with the former president also winning the popular vote by an estimated three million votes. Republicans flipped three Senate seats previously held by Democrats in West Virginia, Ohio, and Montana. They appear likely to pick up a fourth seat in Pennsylvania as well, but an automatic statewide recount has been issued and should be concluded before Thanksgiving.

Several House races remain uncalled as of last Friday, including four from California. Those include Reps. Jim Costa, John Duarte, Josh Harding, and Michelle Steel. No matter the results, Republicans will once again have a razor-thin majority in the lower chamber, with current Speaker Mike Johnson (LA) retaining the top post after a conference vote last week. In the Senate, South Dakota Sen. John Thune won an internal vote to serve as the Majority Leader. He will replace Sen. Mitch McConnell (KY), who announced his plans to step down earlier this year.

The incoming administration is set to nominate several Congressional members to serve in Cabinet roles, and while this could complicate the voting math in the House early on for Republicans, all currently known nominees occupy reliably safe GOP-held positions, and special election talks are already underway. Ultimately, we anticipate significant changes in policy focus under the Republican trifecta. Taxes, trade, and border security remain key issue areas that could have direct impacts on agriculture early on. We will certainly update members as those priorities take shape through the transition process.

USDA Proposes Final FMMO Changes

USDA's Agricultural Marketing Service issued a final decision on a proposal to amend the uniform pricing formulas for all 11 Federal Milk Marketing Orders (FMMO), which govern the prices for different classes of milk across the country. Changes made back in 2018 were largely seen as harmful to the dairy industry throughout much of the COVID-19 pandemic and in the years following. The proposals cap a two-year process to solicit feedback from the industry on how to best alter the system to better serve dairy producers. The four main changes include: a reduction in the delayed implementation of the revised skim milk composition factors from 12 months to 6 months; adding a $0.0015 marketing cost factor in all make allowances; a modification to the methodology used to determine the nonfat dry milk make allowance; and limited changes to certain county-specific Class I differentials. USDA released an economic analysis of how the various orders would have been impacted by the proposed changes, generally showing gains for most. CAFB will be reviewing this with other ag partners to assess how these changes will look moving forward. A vote is scheduled at the beginning of the year for any producer whose milk is pooled in an FMMO.

Prospects Fade on Farm Bill

With the election now in the rearview mirror, lawmakers returned to DC with hopes of addressing a litany of "lame duck" priorities. Much of the ag world was hopeful this would include a full reauthorization of the Farm Bill, but the longshot bid seems to have lost steam. Instead, it appears Congress might be shifting focus to disaster funding and a possible "economic assistance" cash infusion for a select few row crops. It remains to be seen whether the two will be combined with a one-year

"AG NEWS" continued on page 13

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2024 ANNUAL MEETING **RECAP**

Thank You to our 2024 Annual Meeting sponsors!

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Photos by Bridgett Reid

President Shane Bickner awarded KCFB board members Garrett Gilcrease, Julie Martella, and Helen Sullivan with this year's President's awards for their hard work, dedication and leadership throughout 2024. These individuals were pivotal in the lawsuit against the SWRCB, led KCFB committees and volunteered countless hours to the organization.

The first ever Pete Hanse Lifetime Achievement Award

Earlier this year, KCFB's Board of Directors recognized the need to honor one of our board members for his many years of service to Kings County Agriculture and our organization. After many conversations and much consideration, the board created the Pete Hanse Lifetime Achievement Award to honor Mr. Hanse and 56 years of service as a director of the Kings County Farm Bureau. This award will continue to be presented to members of our board and community that the Board of Directors feel exemplify the hard work and dedication that Mr. Hanse has shown over the many years of his service to Farm Bureau.

As KCFB's current Executive Director, it has been on honor to work with a get to know Pete. The Hanse family has welcomed me into their home on several occasions where we've talked KCFB, agriculture in general, talked about family and friends. I have never met a more dedicated individual to Farm Bureau than Pete. On my first visit to Pete and Janice's house after a great conversation Pete was walking out and we walked past a wall of family pictures and commendations Pete has received. He stopped at a photo from one of the many California Farm Bureau Annual Meetings he attended on behalf of KCFB telling me that was one of the photos on the wall that he was the proudest of. I think about that interaction with Pete a lot and it serves as a great reminder of what KCFB is about and the positive impact a small group of good people can have on the world. It was my honor to present the first ever Pete Hanse Lifetime Achievement Award to Mr. Hanse at the KCFB Annual Meeting on Thursday November 14th. This award was a surprise to Pete, but not his family. His lovely wife Janice Hanse gathered four tables full of Pete's family and friends to witness the award not to mention the other 260 people in the room that night that have been impacted by Pete's service in one way or another.

Kings County Farm Bureau would not only like to thank Pete Hanse for his years of unmatched dedication and service, but his wife Janice's service as well. The Hanse family has been a champion for Farm Bureau and our efforts for over five decades, and this organization would not be the same without them.

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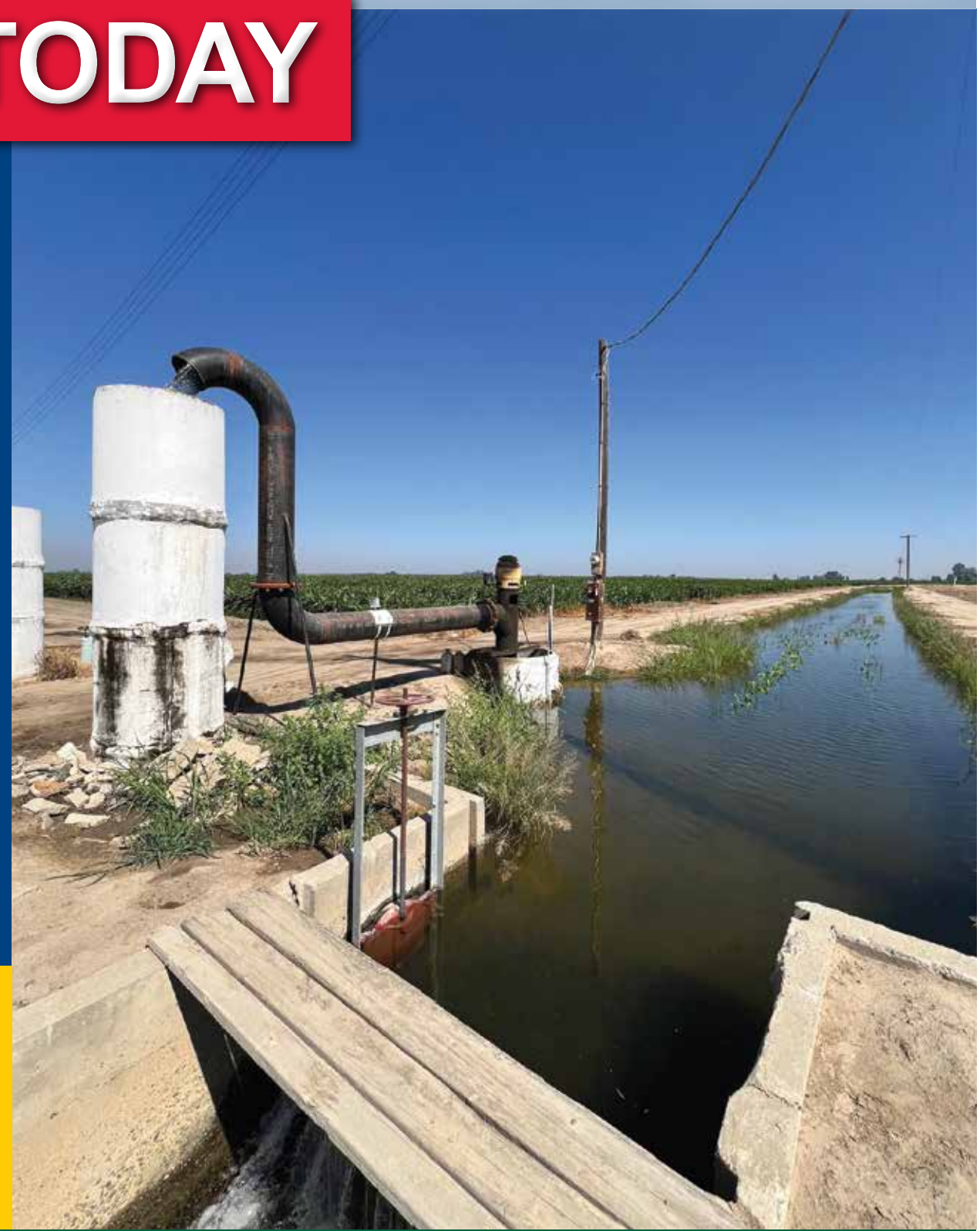
If you have questions about your current sponsorship, would like to renew or join as a Friend of Farm Bureau, please contact Breanna at the KCFB office. 559-584-3557 or at blarman@kcfb.org

SGMA **Defense Fund**

INVEST TODAY



KCFB believes that we can win our case against the SWRCB! To date, KCFB has invested almost a quarter million dollars in legal fees to protect Kings County growers right to farm. We expect to need another $250,000 to continue the battle to undo the probationary status of the Tulare Lake Sub-basin in 2025. This is your money, fighting for you. Protect your heritage!

Help us fight for you!

Contact KCFB by phone at **559-584-3557**, via email at **kcfb@kcfb.org**, or visit the KCFB website for more information.

How you can help:

$8 per acre: Growers in the Tulare Sub-basin

$4 per acre: GSA Organizations

$4 per acre: Growers outside the Tulare Sub-basin

Business Support Levels: $2,500 • $5,000 • $10,000

Please make checks payable to Kings County Farm Bureau and include SGMA Defense Fund on the memo line.

SGMA DEFENSE RECAP

2024 SWRCB Lawsuit Recap

APRIL

Expenses $31,873

- KCFB's Water Committee interviewed 7 different lawyers to represent us in this case before deciding our on current counsel
- April 16th: Provided comments on behalf of KCFB's members to the SWRCB at the Tulare Lake Subbasin Probationary Hearing

MAY

Expenses $28,057

- KCFB filed the challenge against the SWRCB in superior court
- The SGMA Defense Fund was launched

JUNE

Expenses $44,231

- Multiple meetings with legal counsel preparing for court appearances

JULY

Expenses $70,836

- July 15th: KCFB was issued a temporary restraining order against the SWRCB pausing the need to register wells, record groundwater pumping and reporting to the SWRCB and the fees associated with both

AUGUST

Expenses $49,217

- August 20th: KCFB attended the preliminary injunction Hearing against the SWRCB

SEPTEMBER

Expenses $32,920

- September 13th: KCFB was awarded a preliminary injunction continuing the pause on pumping fees and recording in the subbasin and limiting the SWRCB to take action in the Tulare Lake Subbasin
- Attended a Case Management Conference
- September 20th: Bond Conference

OCTOBER

Expenses $32,920

The SWRCB appealed the Preliminary Injunction granted to KCFB

APRIL

PRESS RELEASES

KCFB

For Immediate Release:
May 16, 2024

CONTACT: Dusty Ference
559.303.1885 cell
Dusty.ference@kcfb.org

KINGS COUNTY FARM BUREAU CHALLENGES STATE WATER RESOURCES CONTROL BOARD

KCFB

For Immediate Release:
June 11, 2024

CONTACT: Dusty Ference
559.303.1885 cell
Dusty.ference@kcfb.org

KINGS COUNTY FARM BUREAU CREATES A SGMA DEFENSE FUND

KCFB

For Immediate Release:
July 16, 2024

CONTACT: Dusty Ference
559.303.1885 cell
Dusty.ference@kcfb.org

JUDGE ISSUES TEMPORARY RESTRAINING ORDER AGAINST STATE WATER RESOURCES CONTROL BOARD

KCFB

For Immediate Release:
August 20, 2024

CONTACT: Dusty Ference
559.303.1885 cell
Dusty.ference@kcfb.org

JUDGE EXTENDS TRO ISSUED JULY 15, 2024, AGAINST THE STATE WATER RESOURCES CONTROL BOARD PROBATIONARY DESIGNATION FOR THE TULARE LAKE SUBBASIN UNDER SGMA

KCFB

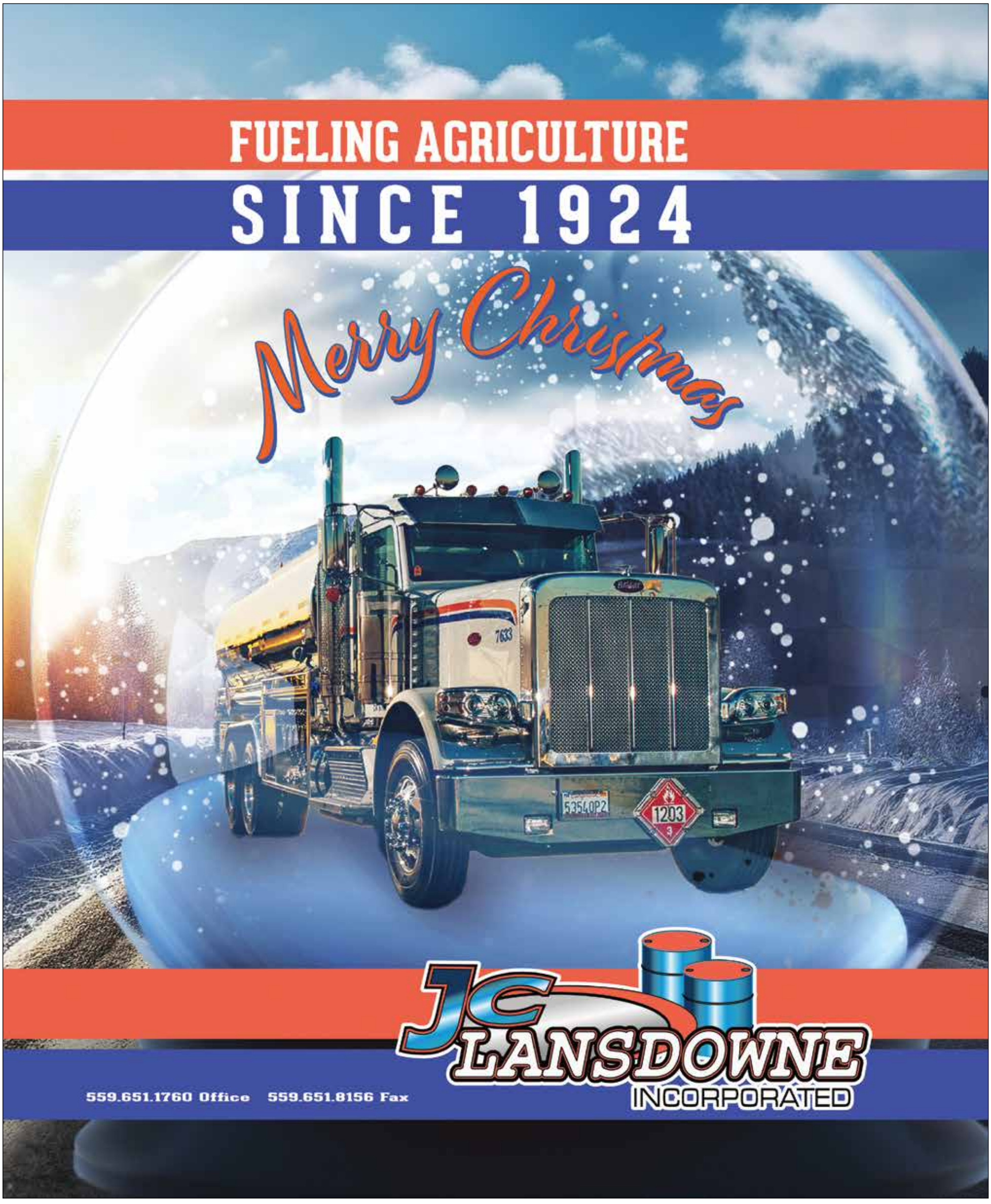
For Immediate Release:
September 13, 2024

CONTACT: Dusty Ference
559.303.1885 cell
Dusty.ference@kcfb.org

JUDGE ISSUES PRELIMINARY INJUNCTION AGAINST THE SWRCB

Hanford, Calif. — On September 12th, Kings County Superior Judge Ciuffini issued a preliminary injunction to KCFB against the California State Water Resources Control Board (SWRCB). This ruling means that all Tulare Lake Subbasin probationary requirements remain paused until the case goes to trial. A trial date has not been set at this time. "Being granted the preliminary injunction is a monumental win for Kings County Farm Bureau and California agriculture. Receiving today's ruling highlights the validity of our claims and showcases our likelihood to win in court in the future" said Dusty Ference, Executive Director of Kings County Farm Bureau.

In today's court proceedings Judge Ciuffini ruled on the four demurrers submitted by the SWRCB. Sustaining 3 and overruling one. "Having Judge Ciuffini sustain our three demurrers justifies our challenge of the decision to be put on probation and we think speaks highly for our chances of further success when the case goes to trial," said Ference. After Judge Ciuffini ruled on the demurrers, the court transitioned into a case management conference. KCFB will be back in court in January 2025 for a second case management conference.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Ag Commissioner's Compliance Report

Jimmy Hook, Agricultural Commissioner/Sealer

Annual Crop Report and Nutria Update

Contributed by Mario Gutierez

Each year, the Kings County Agricultural Commissioner collects crop and livestock data for the annual Crop Report. The Commissioner is mandated by law to report on the acreage and value of agricultural production in the county, and relies heavily on information provided by the local agricultural community to complete the report.

Yearly we reach out to Kings County's growers and producers through various means to help collect county production data. With the yearly permit renewal letter growers received a crop reporting form listing their crops and respective acreage as it appears on their permit. Growers are asked to fill in the blanks regarding their crop production. Once completed, the information is returned via email, fax or can be brought into our office when renewing the permit. Persistence by staff has enabled us to account for 80% – 90% of the acreage for many commodities, making the report an accurate reflection of the county's agricultural value. All information provided by growers is considered confidential, every effort is made to ensure this throughout the reporting process. The time spent by growers providing this information is very much appreciated by the department!

Kings Counties' 2023 crop values saw the gross value of all agricultural crops and products produced decrease by $438,695,000. This overall decrease was in large part due to historic flooding caused by atmospheric rivers that passed over California during the winter and the decreases in the value and production of milk in the Livestock category, which experienced the largest decrease in value at $301,043,000. Field crops decreased in value by $208,345,000 due to lower planted acreage and decreased values of cotton, alfalfa, safflower, corn silage and wheat crops. Vegetable crops were $11,666,000 down in value from 2022. Unfortunately, the crops that increased in value were not enough to offset reductions. It is important to note that values listed in the report are gross values and do not represent income or loss to producers.

Many different businesses, organizations, agencies, and individuals utilize the annual crop report. These include agricultural suppliers, farm credit organizations, agricultural research and educational facilities, transportation agencies, and farm labor offices. Even individual ranchers and growers use the report for comparison to other producers and for planning future production. Our office utilizes the data when disasters such as droughts and storms strike the local farming community. By taking the 5-year crop values and plugging in the acres damaged, we can calculate the total value loss to the county for the various incidents. These values are used should any disaster relief funds become available.

Again, thanks and appreciation are extended to the many producers and organizations who contribute every year to our report.

Nutria Update

Typically 2 feet in length and weighing 15-20 pounds, Nutria a light to dark brown fur bearing semi-aquatic rodent, can be mistaken for a muskrat or beaver. It can severely impact the state's resources, causing the loss of wetlands, severe soil erosion, damage to agricultural crops and levees and reduced stability of banks, dikes and roadbeds. The pest was eradicated from

California in 1978 but was detected again in Merced County in March 2017. The California Department of Fish and Wildlife began efforts to detect and control the rodent but recently more than 500 sightings have been noted within the Sacramento-San Joaquin Delta. One nutria can eat five pounds of vegetation daily, while destroying up to 20 pounds in the process, which is devastating to California's natural wetland systems. Boots on the ground utilizing over 400 cameras search for the rodent and last year two dogs, trained to detect Nutria scat were sent from a state with a previous infestation to aid in the effort.

As of the first week of October 2024, 5,208 Nutria have been taken statewide since they were first detected in March of 2017. Most detections have been found in Merced, Fresno, Stanislaus and Solano Counties representing 5,032 taken. The California Department of Fish and Wildlife is the state agency carrying out the surveying and trapping activities. Suspected observations or potential signs of nutria in California should be photographed and immediately reported to CDFW, by email to Invasive@wildlife.ca.gov or by calling (866) 440-9530. The Kings County Agricultural Commissioner is also responding to possible sightings of the pest by visual surveying, as well as utilizing trail cams. To date there has been no confirmed sightings in Kings County, but the department continues to survey. For questions, please call our office at 559-852-2830.

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What to expect to 2025

By Breanna Larman

Breanna Larman

What goes "Oh Oh Oh"?
Santa walking backwards.

With the positive momentum from our State Water Resources Control Board case kicking off the new year, 2025 is shaping up to be an exciting year for KCFB. With advocacy work at our forefront, we expect 2025 be full of the same hard work but rewarding efforts that saw this year. Despite the hard work, we will also have some fun. We have scheduled our third Annual Membership Appreciation Night at the Visalia Rawhide Ballpark in May, our Harvest Classic Golf Tournament in October and of course our new favorite, Annual Meeting. Just a reminder, that Farm Day has been transferred to the Kings County Office of Education. Farm Day will still be held at the Kings Fairgrounds in March of 2025. If you are interested in participating as a presenter or as a volunteer, please contact Ruth at the Office of Education. 559-589-7026

As we close the door on 2024, lots of new opportunities for 2025 are opening! If you are interested in being a 2025 advertiser with KCFB, we are offering ad space in Farm Life print, Farm Life Online and on our new Farm Life Podcast. A great way to utilize all of the marketing platforms KCFB interacts with our community on is becoming a Friend of Farm Bureau. We are excited for new and returning sponsors to take advantage of our newly built Friend of Farm Bureau pricing and benefits structure. Advertising space for 2025 is open for contracts, limited space is available so make sure to renew or sign up soon! If you are interested in any of these opportunities or have questions, please reach out to Bre at the KCFB office by phone or email. 559-584-3557 or blarman@kcfb.org

"AG NEWS" continued from page 13

reauthorization of the Farm Bill, or if they will take another approach altogether. Outgoing Sen. Debbie Stabenow (MI) remains a central figure in the Senate for getting a full reauthorization done, but reports are mixed on her willingness to see it happen. Republicans winning control of the Senate could mean some of the Farm Bill might go back to 'square one' in the new Congress, meaning an early passage would be unlikely.

Clean Truck Check Enforcement

Beginning Tuesday, November 19, 2024, the California Air Resources Board (CARB) will require all vehicles entering California ports and railyards to be compliant with Clean Truck Check. To avoid any disruptions in operation, please ensure that your vehicle(s) are compliant with the Clean Truck Check program by: • Reporting vehicles in the Clean Truck Check database (CTC-VIS) • Ensure the annual compliance fee is paid by the deadline noted in your CTC-VIS account on January 1, 2025. You may test up to 90 days prior to the vehicle's testing deadline to provide time for any necessary repairs. To support a smooth transition, vehicles denied access due to non-compliance will have the option to apply for a 5-day pass to provide temporary access while annual compliance fees are processed after the vehicle has been reported. Payment Processing Times • Credit or Debit Card Payments: Processed within 1-2 business days. • eChecks: This can take up to 7 business days. To minimize disruptions and avoid delays, we encourage you to address compliance requirements as soon as possible.

Kings County Rural Crime Report

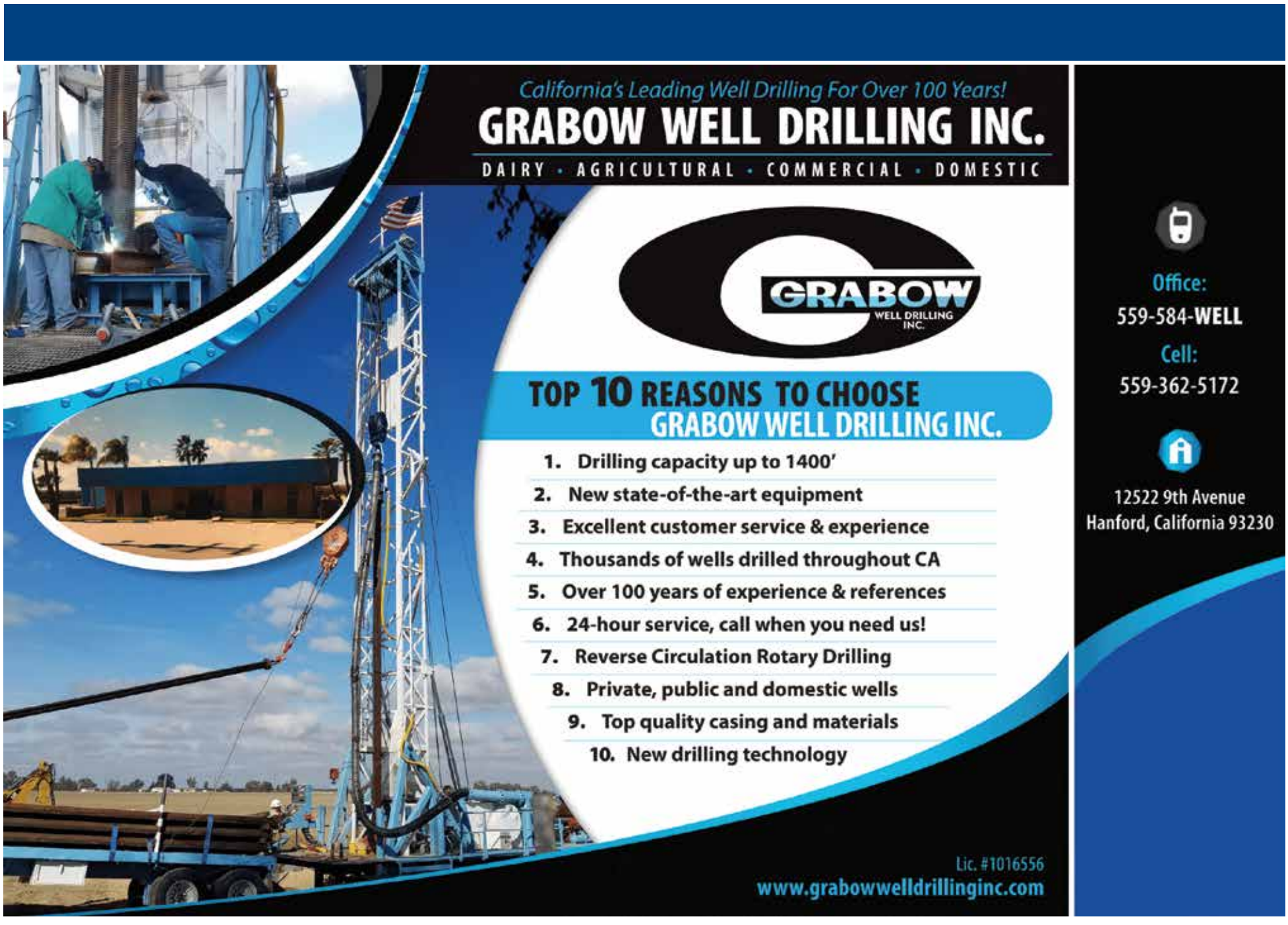
The Kings County Sheriff's Office Rural Crime Task Force is currently conducting several investigations.

November: Throughout the month of November, the Kings County Rural Crimes Task Force has continued to stay busy investigating diesel theft, copper wire theft, porta potty and heavy equipment theft. This past month, we have seen a rise in equipment theft in the north side of the county along with copper wire theft. These types of cases are difficult to investigate but our unit has been writing geofence warrants, setting up trail cameras and following up with recycling centers to identify suspects and bring them into custody.

Our unit worked alongside Fresno County ag. unit and together we were able to locate a stolen trailer and welder in the 16200 block of Fowler Ave, Selma. Suspects were captured on surveillance footage stealing equipment and were identified as Joshua James Morton, Austin Lane Shearer and Blair William Delgado. The suspects were arrested and charged accordingly. Our unit was located and recovered a stolen jack rabbit around I5 and Avenal Cutoff after receiving a call for service stating someone was dismantling the farm equipment. Ag. detectives arrived on scene and recovered jack rabbit. The ag. task force has been working alongside fish and game to target marijuana grows near the south side of Kings County and have successfully recovered stolen farm equipment while executing the search warrants. The farm equipment that was recovered was being used for the marijuana grows.

Detective Fausnett **(559) 639-8704**
Detective Thomas **(559) 530-1701**
Detective Coghlan **(559) 362-3078**
DA Investigator Ward **(559) 309-6367**

As always it is imperative that if anyone knows of or hears of any buying or selling obviously stolen equipment, to call the Sheriff's Office. We continue to investigate all Ag related thefts and encourage members to call and report all Ag related crimes. If we do not receive calls from our members and community, we may not be aware of certain crimes occurring in your area.



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